

Postal too

A man in Cleveland, USA killed a postgraduate student, and injured two others by firing in rage, when his Web site destroyed by a hacker. Biswanath Halder, believed that Shawn Miller, a school computer lab assistant hacked his site and destroyed his life's work. Halder tried to convict Miller in the civil courts, and made numerous complaints to the university president, the campus police, the Mayor of Cleveland, the FBI and even the US House and Senate Judiciary Committees.

Halder was a loner and was unable to get a job for last 15 years. He used to sue companies that did not take him. He thought he possessed the secrets to peace and prosperity and shared his secrets through his Web site. He said in court, "I try to solve mankind's problems through the Internet. In a few seconds, the evil man wiped out everything that it took my lifetime to create."

Halder has been living on disability pension for some years and thus was unable to afford psychiatric treatment.

snapshot

There are approximately **38,118,962** Web sites on the **WWW**. **57.62%** of the Web sites run on Apache Web server while **31.87%** use Microsoft IIS

Source: netcraft, 2002

'X' marks the box

Keen on boosting the sales of the Xbox, Microsoft announced new additions and improvements for the game console just before this year's Electronic Entertainment Expo (E3) show. The announcement included exclusive game such as Halo 2, Project Gotham Racing 2 and Crimson Skies: High Road to Revenge coupled with an Xbox version of Counter Strike. All these have innovative online gameplay modes.

New features for its online gameplay system Xbox Live are also being introduced. It now has the ability to page a friend's mobile device with an invitation to play, and even a place to meet online and use voice-chat. Microsoft is hoping to have at least a 100 Xbox Live games by mid next year.

Another add-on; the Music Mixer, will be available as a \$40 (Rs 1,900) package later this year. This will allow

players to transfer music and images from their PCs to their Xbox consoles. The software supports 2D and 3D visualisations, and lets you make playlists and sing along to your favourite tunes, with lyric-stripping technology.



XSN Sports is a line up of sports games that let you form your own leagues and maintain stats on www.xsnsports.com, making it a more comprehensive experience.

Meanwhile, a new book titled "Hacking the Xbox: an Introduction to Reverse Engineering", is being sold by the author Andrew 'Bunnie' Huang, on his Web site. According to Huang, the book is so controversial that the publishers are afraid to publish it. So he's taken it upon himself to publish it in its entirety. The Web site says "Hacking the Xbox looks forward and discusses the impact of today's legal challenges on legitimate reverse engineering activities."

Mobiles threaten planes

Standard cell phone use can cause serious threats to planes by creating interference with the aircraft's navigation system, according to a recent research done by The Civil Aviation Authority, at UK. Mobile phones cause the plane compasses to freeze or overshoot and navigation bearings to be inaccurate.

A poster on the Professional Pilots' Rumour Network—a popular online community for airline pilots and crew, says,

"Occasionally during the taxi out, we overhear the characteristic chirping of a mobile phone through our headsets. More often than not, it turns out to be a crew phone; we switch it off, and then continue with no ill effects. Sometimes, however, it becomes necessary to hold clear of the runway and make an announcement reminding passengers to switch their phones off."



heroes

Apple's new iPod
Apple has launched a redesigned iPod in 15 and 30 GB versions. The redesign improves on the earlier beauty making it even smaller than its predecessor and lighter. It now sports four backlit buttons between the wheel and the display.

Mobile gaming
With its dominance in the gaming console market well established with the PS2, Sony now plans to launch the PlayStation Portable (PSP). This will take on Nintendo's GameBoy Advance, which has enjoyed a virtual monopoly. The new PSP will also play music and video. Sony wants to make it "the walkman of the 21st century". Nokia also plans to enter this market with its N-Gage gaming phone.

zeroes

SCO Group
The SCO Group has sent legal notice to 1,500 of the world's largest corporations claiming they may be liable for the use of Linux since they claim it is "an unauthorized derivative of UNIX" to which SCO holds the rights". According to SCO, since Linux distributors do not warrant the 'legal integrity' of the Linux code, the user may be liable for its development and use.

Spyware and Adware
Studies show 493 types of spyware lurking on 1,317 Web sites, up from 56 types on 125 Web sites a year ago. Adware with KaZaA and other such applications tracks browsing habits and reports them to advertisers. Visit www.spywareinfo.com or www.doxdesk.com for help online.